Commentary on the Tantra Called Glorious Anāvila

Śrī Anāvilanāmatantrapañjikā · Toh 1204 · Derge Tengyur
དཔལ་རྨོངས་པ་མདེ་པ་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་རྒྱུད་ཀྱི་ཟླུམ་པོ

The Commentary on the Tantra Called Glorious Anāvila, in Sanskrit Śrī Anāvila Nāma Tantra Pañjikā and in Tibetan Pal Nyokpa Mepa Zhé Jawé Gyü kyi Drelpa, is an Indian commentary on the difficult points of the Anāvila Tantra, composed by the master and monk Kumāracandra. The tantra's name means "free of turbidity," and the commentary opens by explaining this as freedom from the turbidity of mental engagement and from the habitual tendencies of ignorance, then works through the tantra passage by passage, glossing its words in terms of the wisdom of the buddhas. It relates the tantra's teaching to figures such as Vairocana, identified with the mirror-like wisdom, and Akṣobhya, and it concludes that the ultimate result is the Blessed One Vajradhara, who embodies the five buddha bodies and great bliss; its colophon calls the root text a king of mahāyoga tantras. The work is Toh 1204 in the Tengyur, where it is placed among the commentaries on the tantras.

In the language of India: śrī anavila nāma tantra pañcika
In the language of Tibet: Commentary on the Tantra Called Glorious Anāvila

Homage to Glorious Anāvila.

Bowing to the Blessed One, Anāvila,
I, Kumāracandra, shall here compose
This stainless commentary on the difficult points
Of the Anāvila, just as it is.

On the passage beginning "Free of turbidity" (anāvila): turbidity is the turbidity of mental engagement. It is, moreover, the aggregates together with ignorance, which means the habitual tendencies of ignorance. "Free of turbidity" means that, because the turbidity of mental engagement has been abandoned, there are no habitual tendencies of ignorance; this is another way of saying that all wrongdoing, together with its habitual tendencies, has been abandoned without remainder. That is to say, the meaning is that one should strive in order to abandon completely the afflictive and cognitive obscurations together with their habitual tendencies. For ignorance together with its habitual tendencies is the source of all faults. In one in whom there is no

ignorance together with its habitual tendencies, how could other habitual tendencies of faults arise? When that is absent, what fault could there be? Therefore "free of turbidity" is the very absence of the two obscurations together with all their habitual tendencies.

That one free of turbidity, moreover, is Glorious Vajrasattva. This presents the subject matter, and it shows the perfection of his own welfare. In the words "wishing to benefit," the attainment of the state of Vajradhara is the purpose, for the Blessed One makes beings into Vajradharas. With these words, what is called the perfection of others' welfare is expressed.

That one free of turbidity is, moreover, shown through eight particulars, the attributes of being free of turbidity, beginning with "without appearance." Here, turbidity is every reference to the conceptual elaborations of the three realms. Since that is not present in this, "without appearance" here means free of conceptual elaboration; it is another way of saying "nonreferential."

"Not without appearance" means that wisdom itself is not of the nature of appearance; or else it is another way of saying "since here the absence of appearance is not an appearance." For it is not present in that, that itself also does not exist, and it does not exist as its cause. This is explained in three ways.

"Without example" means this: since there is no second object of measure equal to it, nothing can be set forth as an example, and so it is without equal and without peer. That is the meaning of "without example." And since there is no object of measure other than it, by the meaning of "without example" there is no second thing equal to it. Beings are of its very nature: since beings have it as their nature, how could it have an example?

"Inexpressible" means that it is not something to be expressed: it is not the domain of words, and it lies beyond the domain of conception and analysis, for it is a body whose nature is nothing but its own perfect awareness. "Not inexpressible" means that it is not inexpressible and is the very absence of all expression without exception; that is, it means that it cannot be expressed and cannot be pointed out.

"Not having the nature of an object" means that it is not an object even of a buddha's intellect, because it cannot be known. Its not having the nature of an object, moreover, means apprehension by a subject that has no intrinsic nature, because there is no error. As for being without an apprehender because nothing is apprehended: an apprehender is something mistaken, and

the nature of reflexive direct perception is explained as the defining characteristic of the unmistaken Blessed One.

From the very outset it is stainless by its essential nature: since it is independent, it is utterly at peace, because by its essential nature all faults, the veils of obscuration, have been abandoned. This means that it is completely pure by its essential nature from the very beginning. This teaches the body of the innate Vajradhara.

Being free of adventitious stains is also twofold: being free of the stains of the afflictions, and being free of the stains of the cognitive obscurations. Of these, because the afflictive obscurations have been abandoned, it is called "selfless," and this expresses the perfection of abandonment. Because the cognitive obscurations have been abandoned, it is called "pure," and this is the perfection of attainment. These show the perfection of his own welfare, which is twofold through the distinction between what the Blessed One has abandoned and what he has attained.

The basis of characterization is to be examined. The abandonment of these is the meaning of "nonconceptual." Both the basis of characterization, which is the entity to be characterized, and the defining characteristic, by which one examines it, are conceptual thought, and so they are "examination"; these have been abandoned. The meaning is that it itself cannot be examined by anyone at all, nor is it a conceiver of anything else. This teaches that it is free of conceptual thought.

Even with reference to the dharmakāya, it has abandoned being an entity to be characterized; and as for defining characteristics, it has abandoned the form body, the marks and body of a great being. The word "and" is construed in its restrictive sense, following the sequence: that very one is qualified by the attributes beginning with "without appearance." That very one means the Blessed One, Glorious Anāvila; it is another way of saying Vajrasattva, who is the intrinsic nature of the perfect Buddha, the Dharma of essential nature, the reality of the yoginīs, and who has the essential nature of all the tathāgatas.

As it is said: "Son of the Victor, that recollection of the Buddha is neither from form nor from the uncharacterized Dharma. Where there is no mind and no movement of mentation, there, in that way, one should recollect the Buddha as indivisible." And it is said:

Whoever sees me as form,
Whoever hears me as sound,

Has strayed onto a mistaken path;
That person does not see me.
The guides are the dharmakāya;
The buddhas are seen as dharmatā.
Dharmatā, as something to be known,
Is not examined even by the Victor.

"Form" here means the major and minor marks. The Dharma itself is the Dharma of the teachings. "Mind" means the seven collections of consciousness. "Mentation" means the collection of afflicted consciousness. "As form" means by way of the major and minor marks. Both are rejected, since by both one engages with the Blessed One himself; since that is seeing what is not reality, all of it is rejected by this, and so it is the dharmatā of phenomena. Dharmatā is the suchness of phenomena. "Dharmakāya" means the body of Dharma. "As something to be known" is to be taken as an indirect indication. "What even the Victor does not examine" means that, since it is not an object of the intellect, what it is cannot be characterized. With these, the dharmakāya has been explained.

The word "benefit" indicates the two, the enjoyment body (saṃbhogakāya) and the emanation body (nirmāṇakāya); since it is through them that the welfare of beings is accomplished, the three bodies are taught. And with the words about the three bodies, the five wisdoms that operate indivisibly from them are also explained. This teaches the result.

This very passage beginning "Free of turbidity" also teaches the path whose defining characteristic is inconceivability. "Free of turbidity" is what is unadulterated, and so it means unadulterated. This extends as far as the word "luminous." "Benefit" here means that the three bodies themselves cannot be conceived anywhere at all: since there is no appearance of anything to be apprehended, there is no apprehender here. That is the meaning of "inconceivable." "Without example" here means that there is no second path that brings about the attainment of Vajradhara. It is "inexpressible" because it is inconceivable. It means that even inwardly it is not of the nature of an object of thought. Being free of excitement, it is peaceful. Since there is no slackness, torpor or sleep, it is selfless. Being free of regret and doubt, it is pure.

"Unthinkable" is the abandonment of the basis of characterization as something to be thought of, and of the defining characteristic as that which

thinks; it means without thinking. This sense of abandoning the basis of characterization and the defining characteristic is the reverse of the earlier "without appearance" and "nature of an object." For that path is not thought of by anything else, nor does it think of anything else, and so it is "without appearance." Moreover, there is no object whatsoever, and since there is no object, it means that it itself is not of the nature of an object. Since it does not think of anything else, the first two words are from the side of the other.

This path too, since it has no imagined entity of its own, means that it itself does not exist; this is another way of saying "without characteristic." It means that there is no conceptualization abiding in its own continuum. Since it cannot be examined by itself, by the sense of "without characteristic," examining even itself is another way of saying rendering it without intrinsic nature. Since what continues as a stream, in the manner of the earlier and later moments of the stream, does not depend on the two, what is thought of and what thinks, it has in itself no nature of thinking or of being thought of. These, from its own side, are the words "without a basis of characterization" and "without a defining characteristic." The sense of "from its own side" is also to be understood in two ways, with respect to the stream and with respect to the moment; this is the distinction made in terms of self and other. These two words teach the body of the inconceivable path; with this, the path has been explained.

"Buddha" is a superimposition. That reality is not something to be thought of; it is unthinkable. If one thinks, "Then what is to be done?", the passage beginning "Buddhas" shows that, just as the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, by the force of their former aspirations and with great compassion that has no object of reference, focus on the benefit of the various beings in each of their ways, one should oneself send forth emanations without effort. "Uninterrupted" refers to enlightened activity. It means that, abiding in reality, one should abide in spontaneously accomplished practice in order to accomplish nonconceptual samādhi.

The passage beginning "Some" refutes what is not accepted, namely an emptiness that is utterly empty, like a flower in the sky, and devoid of the fearlessnesses and so forth. "Is proclaimed" indicates that it is not accepted. "Likewise" refers to the nature immediately continuous with emptiness and the rest. "Of the cause" means what is posited by the intellect. The passage beginning "Result" refers to the innate Vajradhara, the nature of the dharmadhātu, inconceivable in every way; it is the seeing of the body of

essential nature and of the nature of reality. Awakening is the result: what is to be actualized, the knowledge of exhaustion and of non-arising. Meditation is the path. The result is what is produced; the cause is what produces. Since these are not established, they are not innate, not complete and not entities, and they are negated by valid cognition; so what this expresses is that they themselves are without intrinsic nature. A cause is a cause in dependence on a result, and a result is a result in dependence on a cause. What is it that is established in dependence? Something unestablished. That is to say, as for the Blessed One: the beginning is arising, and the end is cessation. Since these are absent in him, it is his very nature that is so described, for he is free of causes and conditions.

The passage beginning "Seeing" teaches the emanations of this accomplishment of the Great Seal (mahāmudrā), since they arise from the culmination of clarity in the illusion-like samādhi. Illusion-like wisdom is the very knowledge of all phenomena as like illusions, whose nature is to make directly manifest the perfect awakening in which all phenomena are like illusions. Through the power of meditating on that wisdom, illusion-like wisdom of various aspects arises; the meaning is that one who possesses that wisdom emanates in this way and that. "Imagined" means the aspect that is mentally fashioned. "Buddhas" are the tathāgatas. "Vajra-bearers" are the Vajradharas. The words "and so on" mean by bodhisattvas and others. "Imagined by them" means that they send forth emanations.

Now I shall set out the arrangement of the maṇḍala. The passage beginning "Abiding well in that" first presents the arrangement of the maṇḍala to be meditated upon. "Abiding well" means abiding, that is, being unmoving; it means having abandoned faults such as doubt. "The aspect of suchness" is so called because it gathers all its attributes, such as being unborn from the very outset, at peace from the beginning, and "equal to space." Since it is the domain of that aspect, it is "the object": whatever phenomena are objects of reference, they are likewise. "Phenomena" means objects of reference. "Essential nature" is the naturally luminous emptiness. "Primordially pure" is the statement; "free of turbidity" is its explanation, meaning completely pure by nature. This is the description. It is by a yogin who wishes to benefit himself and others. For that very reason, the maṇḍala of the mind and the maṇḍala of colored powders are taught. "The aggregates and so on" pertains to the colored-powder maṇḍala; the words "and so on" indicate the sense sources. "Particular" means a particular of realization. To show what indicates the

aggregates and the rest, it says "body" and so on; the meaning is that body and the rest are not distinct from the aggregates and the rest.

For apart from the three, body and the rest, the elements and the sense sources do not exist; the three vajras themselves are what is meant by the aggregates, the sense sources and the elements. "That" means that very maṇḍala. "Is declared" presents it as the maṇḍala of the collection just explained. By this very word, since the aggregates and so on are explained, nonduality is taught. Of the words "and so on," the first is to be taken as the sense sources and the second as the elements. Even what is contaminated is declared to be a maṇḍala whose nature is the path. And when they have become the result, these very uncontaminated maṇḍalas are to be regarded as the uncontaminated aggregates and so on. Here, moral discipline, samādhi, wisdom, and the knowledge and vision of liberation are the aggregates. The leap-over absorption and the rest are the sense sources and the rest. Those sense sources, and the elements, loving-kindness and the rest, are the very absence of intrinsic nature. These teach the nature.

The passage beginning "Mirror-like" gives the reason why it is a square maṇḍala; this teaches the maṇḍala as square. "The four wisdoms" means that they are gathered into four spokes. This word "spoke" is used as a conventional term for the directions. The mirror-like wisdom is first, the eastern spoke. The wisdom of discernment is the southern spoke. The wisdom that accomplishes activities is the northern spoke. The wisdom of equality is the western spoke; "spoke" here means side. These are conceived as square, that is, arranged, by all the buddhas, the Vajradharas.

Wisdom itself is the window, because through it the eye sees each thing as its own object. Or else it is because its sphere of activity is not shown either; it is so called because it engages its own objects as far as they extend. Body, feeling, mind and phenomena, these four, are the four applications of mindfulness; they are the doors. The passage beginning "Declared" teaches the four corners: giving these four, the Dharma, material things, fearlessness and loving-kindness, is the four corners, meaning the intermediate points.

The passage beginning "Center" is to be regarded as the heart of the maṇḍala: the wisdom of the utterly pure dharmadhātu itself is the center of the maṇḍala. All the deities of such a maṇḍala are definitely established at the time of the path; when one has ascertained them and put them into practice, they will come about with certainty at the time of the result.

"Peaceful qualities" is the path in summary, because the aggregates of moral discipline, samādhi, wisdom and so on pacify the obscurations to the path. And the deeds of a buddha, the powers, the fearlessnesses and so on, are themselves the "aim," the aim of persons. Because these are the essence, they are the maṇḍala. The passage beginning "Maṇḍala" also teaches the dharmadhātu itself as the ultimate maṇḍala. "All" means that what is established in all three times is the innate sixth, that which has been transformed. "Peaceful" means at peace from the very beginning: with reference to its being stainless by essential nature, and as the complete pacification of all faults. "Dharma" is the dharmadhātu. That itself is the purpose of the aim, the body of essential nature.

The passage beginning "Net" is the statement; it means, in brief, that the limbs of samādhi themselves are the net and the rest. The passage beginning "Archways" explains the limbs of samādhi in detail. The mind's samādhi brought to the culmination of clarity is the archway. The mind's samādhi operating without deliberate effort is the necklace; this is another way of saying "flowing down." Operating now with deliberate effort, now without it, is the half-net. The very realization of all phenomena as like an echo is the bell. The very teaching that gives rise to all the Dharma of firm conviction is the vajra garland. All the Dharma is twofold: in the form of the Teacher's scripture, and in the form whose nature is realization. Mind itself, which, being free of grasping at nonentities and the like, enters into an equality as boundless as the realm of space and covers it, is the canopy.

Now I shall explain the moments and the four joys. Here the passage beginning "Garlands" teaches joy: the very appearance in the aspect of bliss whose nature is joy, indicated in the moment of variety, is everywhere the garlands, the cloths, the yak-tail fans and so on. The passage beginning "Vajra" is the wisdom of supreme joy, indicated in the moment of maturation. At the time of the vajra and the lotus, the consort and so on, through the mind itself in the aspect of joy and bliss, the joys reach the corners. The passage beginning "Of that vajra meaning" is the innate: since it is not something to be examined by them, it is inert, and it is called "free of characteristics."

The mudrās of the innate ḍākinī are to be meditated upon. Meditation is the nature of one's own part; it is the arising of Saṃvara. The meaning is: Saṃvara born of meditation. The ḍākinī is the Blessed Lady. Saṃvara is the Blessed One, Vajrasattva, or others as well. "As they dawn" means they arise; the meaning is that in the moment free of characteristics the innate itself dawns

as the ḍākinī and Saṃvara.

The passage beginning "Corners" is the joy of cessation. "Vajra jewel": the jewel is the gem. Since it has the nature of enjoying bliss, and because it is specially set apart, the very realization of the joy of joy in the moment without aspects is adorned with vajra jewels at all the junctures of the corners; that is, as is indicated at every angle, the lotuses are gathered, that is, enclosed within. The very beauty of being adorned with vajra jewels is the maṇḍala: it is the vajra-jewel crest.

In the passage beginning "If," "meaning" is the ultimate, reality. Seeing the reality of wisdom is the moon. Seeing the reality of method is the sun. "Wisdom and the rest" is a summing up; "having that as its self" means having that as its nature. The wisdom thus just explained is the realization of everything. "Joined in union" means united. "Without characteristics" means that, having abandoned the characteristics of distinct aspects of this kind and that, it has entered the maṇḍala. That very thing, all the conceptions just explained, is what is expressed as "the stage of Vajradhara of all the buddhas."

Thus, having taught the maṇḍala, on the passage beginning "Fire offering": "nonconceptual" means having abandoned ordinary conceptions without remainder. "Indicating" means mindfulness.

"Investigating" means having come to discern each thing individually from its own nature; it is by this that one investigates what the nature of all entities is. It means the wisdom of emptiness, which destroys all entities. It investigates by discriminating; it is discrimination itself. The utter emptiness of each thing in its own aspect is the fire, because it burns up all grasping at entities. "Is to be burned" means rendering them without intrinsic nature; the meaning is that one should be firmly established in this way. "Arisen from mind" means posited by the mind. Entities such as form are constructed by the mind, and what arises from mind is the sense source of form and the rest. The words "and so on" include the elements as well.

On the passage beginning "Firmly established": the suffix carries the sense of beginning. "Having become stable" means that the mind is unmoving; the mind is present. It is said that those very aspects of body, speech and mind are in essence mind, and all the Teachers say this with one voice. "Having become one" is the very nature of the dharmadhātu.

In the passage beginning "Now," the great secret is introduced as the defining characteristic of mantra. The passage beginning "Unborn and appearing" is the exposition: the unbornness of all phenomena is the meaning of the great secret. In the passage beginning "Deity," it is fitting that the nature is the aggregates themselves and the very taking up of birth. For the worldly intellect in which it thereby abides, that perfect reality is perfect awakening; it is the Perfection of Wisdom. "Determined" means established as a conclusion. "Indicated" means definitively. "Seal" is the Great Seal, and perfect awakening lies in that itself. "Affixing" means making of one taste.

In the passage beginning "The deities," "worship" means practice. "Union" is samādhi, that is, calm abiding and insight. It means: cultivate the mind of awakening in which emptiness and compassion are indivisible. "Great secret" is the seal of the dharmadhātu, the self of all, in the form of the shape of the letter e. "Supreme delight" is the celestial palace. "Always abiding" is said because the nature of the dharmadhātu is unchanging throughout the three times. "The self of all buddhas": since the qualities that are the nature of the five wisdom tathāgatas are present in it, it is the "being" (sattva); this means the abode of all unsurpassed qualities. "Vajra" is emptiness, and "being" is compassion; by joining them there is Vajrasattva. What his body is, is stated as "supreme bliss": the body of great bliss.

"Great secret" is dharmatā. "Supreme" is the body of complete enjoyment. "Delight" is the various emanations. "The self of all" is the body of essential nature. "Always dwells" means that it does not leave the four bodies to go anywhere at all. That which is the self of all buddhas, the self of the Dharma body, the enjoyment body, the emanation body and the body of essential nature, is the "being." If one asks what that is, it is Vajrasattva. That very one, which is "supreme bliss," great bliss, is declared to be the fifth body.

The passage beginning "Cross-legged" teaches the inconceivable yoga. Having meditated on all phenomena as emptiness, one arises in a single instant, seated on a lion throne, upright and majestic like one holding a staff through the yoga of the essence, yellow, and holding vajra and bell. One should meditate on oneself, inconceivable and illusion-like, as having the nature of the all-pervading lord, Glorious Vajrasattva. It is not that "how" refers to meditating as illusion-like; "how" means meditating in this way: "Just as the wisdom that occurs in the three times has arisen, will be generated, and is arising, so I too shall generate it. All you buddhas, bodhisattvas and vajra yoginīs, bless me!" Uttering this blessing of truth, one should make

supplication.

"All" means that one should rely on meditation on the equality of the nature of all entities. Then one should not conceptualize even that, but should abide fully in the yoga of the unthinkable: this is the instruction. Conceptualizing worldly objects and conceptualizing supramundane objects are not the natural state; rather, they are something that has come about. The natural state is the absence of both kinds of conceptualization. Through the yoga of the nature of one's own natural state, one should abide, having given up all application of the mind to phenomena.

As for nonconceptual reality, the meaning of the passage beginning "Six" is this. One should contemplate the nature of the forms of the six universal monarchs (cakravartins): with the thought that the six families have come into union, one should join the two hands palm to palm. Imagining that the gurus, buddhas, bodhisattvas and the rest who fill the whole realm of space know and attend, and having abandoned the various conceptions, however many, of all that is afflicted and all that is purified, whose nature is conceptual thought, one gathers together all those buddhas in front; that is what "assembled" means. They become a single Vajradhara; this means having a body in which they have become one. This is the statement.

Its explanation is the passage beginning "Nature": "own" means that the buddhas, the Vajradharas, abide and attend with a single omniscience. "Become" means abide. Its detailed explanation is the passage beginning "All": the self, the nature, of the buddhas becomes one in their assembly; he is the lord, the one Saṃvara of all the buddhas. Therefore the yogin is perfect awakening itself. The word "also" has the sense of "precisely." The rest is easy to understand.

What was taught in the past by Dīpaṃkara and the others, I, Śākyamuni, have also explained. "That very" means that very commitment of go ku da ha na and the rest, set forth in the treatises of mantra. By just this much, the ox and the others are delimited. "If" means: if, that is, whenever this is the case, then it is the unsurpassed conventional reality of the yogin, which is distinguished from saṃsāra.

It is the cause by which things are posited as ultimately true: supremely and completely pure, it has become the cause of what is to be desired through all the sense pleasures without exception. But it is not the unsurpassed nirvāṇa. What lies on this side of nirvāṇa is saṃsāra itself, for there is no adding of

aggregates.

Now the means of accomplishing the commitment is taught. It is the Perfection of Wisdom, in which nothing at all is realized. In "devotion to it," the seventh case, the locative, is clearly indicated: one should accomplish it with that firm conviction, for one enters into it for the sake of the commitment. Since it is by this that one indicates it and makes it directly perceived, it is the commitment; this is the stage of the tathāgatas' path of accumulation. "To be accomplished" means turning toward the bestowal of the result; or else "to be realized," that is, to be made manifest: this is the commitment, and it is the stage of the result. There is no result of a kind different from the path: compared with the earlier mass of gold, these are like refined gold. For the path, having completely abandoned the two obscurations together with all their habitual tendencies, itself becomes the result just beyond the stage that lasts until the two obscurations come to an end, and abides manifestly. "To be accomplished," meaning to be turned toward, refers to the stage of the path. Manifest awakening, too, belongs to the stage of the result; here the accomplishment is to be made manifest. "By the code of the barbarians (mlecchas)" means mere conventional usage, as the yogin's conventional reality.

The passage beginning "Equality" teaches Ratnasambhava. "Equal" means operating through the nature of the wisdom of equality. Equality is what is common to all sentient beings, and it is dharmatā. Of these, to teach what is common: "attachment" is being attached through great compassion that pervades all sentient beings. As for teaching dharmatā: the sentient beings who would be objects for the unattached do not exist at all. That very nonexistence is the tenet called "equality." In dharmatā sentient beings are not apprehended; even so, the meaning is that compassion works for their benefit. In "bodhisattva," the word "being" (sattva), with the first case standing for the fourth, refers to sentient beings; his seeing them is another way of saying that he works for their benefit.

If someone objects, "Then there is no compassion at all, because it has no object," we reply: there is. If one asks how it works: that very point, that although sentient beings themselves do not exist, suffering and the rest still arise for them intensely, is what is astonishing. As long as they do not know their own nature, they are tormented by their own sufferings and the rest, and so they fall into inversion. Toward those who have fallen into inversion, one engages in intense compassion. "Attached" means Ratnasambhava, the

compassion attached through wisdom. "Enjoyed" means eaten and drunk, that is, realized. "Great attachment" is the body of the wisdom of equality. "Amitābha": since the infinite sentient beings do not exist as entities, it is that in which there is no thought of difference; likewise, it means the wisdom of equality, the precious essence.

"Reaching there" means realizing; in that sense, wisdom is unborn. The meaning is that this is held to be what is called "discernment"; it is another way of saying that the very unbornness of phenomena is the discerning one, Amitābha. Again, "those phenomena" are the phenomena of the glorious vajra. They do not exist: whatever is produced is of that very nature. As it is said:

Phenomena, ever unborn, are the Tathāgata;
All phenomena are like the Sugata.
Those of childish mind, who grasp at signs,
Engage in phenomena that do not exist in the worlds.

The intent is that Amitābha is the nature of nonarising. Its explanation is "unborn." "Fully realizing" means knowing thoroughly, or else the realization of phenomena. "Seminal fluid" is Amitābha; "eating" means making it manifest oneself.

The passage beginning "Equality" is Amoghasiddhi. "Entities" are the entities of sentient beings, which are in equality through Amoghasiddhi: because it engages with sentient beings in common, equality is designated here, and it is the wisdom that accomplishes activities. "Equal": the wisdom that relies on the diligent accomplishment of activities common to all sentient beings is equality. "Entities" is envy; "entity" has the sense of entity-hood itself. It is another way of saying Amoghasiddhi, whose nature is the wisdom that accomplishes activities. "Flesh" is eaten through the nonreferential yoga of Amoghasiddhi, whose nature is the wisdom that accomplishes activities; that is, one brings it under one's own power. Alternatively, "entities" are sentient beings: by practicing the activity through the application of nonreference toward sentient beings, the meaning is that sentient beings too are not apprehended.

The passage beginning "Fully expanded" is Akṣobhya. Extending as far as the limits of the realm of space is "expanded." "Radiating" means going everywhere, to each and every sentient being: it is Akṣobhya, whose nature is utterly pure wisdom. "Realizing" means making manifest through perfect awakening itself. "Commitment" is the all-pervading dharmadhātu; its meaning is the object of manifest awakening. "Those who, from union with it"

means from approaching it. "Commitment," too, is the utterly pure wisdom, manifest awakening. "The meaning," too, is the dharmadhātu; it is to be fully realized. Yoga in harmony with that is reaching the state of one taste; it means having that as one's nature. Therefore it means: as Akṣobhya himself, whose nature is the wisdom of the utterly pure dharmadhātu. "In harmony" means causing it to enter one's own continuum. "Action" is said to be activity: realizing the meaning as it is. The action of its union is uniting fully with the chosen deity.

The passage beginning "Anything" explains Vairocana. "Nothing at all" is the mind that rejects positing things as "it is this, it is that": it is the mirror-like wisdom. "Relying" means unshakable: abiding without movement, one is continuously in meditative equipoise. "Manifest appearance" is conceptual thought, since things appear as having a distinct, individual nature; because that is absent, there is no manifest appearance. Not conceptualizing through conceptuality, through the movement of the mind, is the mirror-like wisdom.

Appearing without interruption and appearing clearly: this is because, being free of that clarity which, delimited by place and time, is clear about only a few objects of valid cognition, the mirror-like wisdom reaches the extreme limit of the maṇḍala of knowable things, however far that extends. The meaning is that it is utterly clear, reaching to the limit of all the limitless aggregates of knowable things. The intended sense is that even without thinking, the whole maṇḍala of knowable things is known without exception. The intended sense is that although there is not the slightest thought about even a single thing, everything is nevertheless known. The meaning is that Vairocana himself, whose intrinsic nature is the mirror-like wisdom, is called "the great medicine." "Eating" means being satisfied by unsurpassed wisdom. As for the meaning of "abandoned": wrong understanding is an understanding that immediately conflicts with thought; it is like not going forth. "Likewise," that is, "without wrong understanding," means that immediately upon those things, they are understood just as they are. Moreover, there is no conceptualizing even of the body of Vairocana that has just been explained here; that is, through wisdom that apprehends no object, it is not apprehended as an object. Therefore, even when there is sameness, that is, even though the very states of path and result have become the same, there is no difference between before and after. In this way, earlier, phenomena were presented by way of the mirror-like wisdom, and now, again, phenomena are presented as the Tathāgata: the wording is differentiated by way of property and property-bearer (dharma and

dharmin).

"Those" refers to what has just been explained. The sacred commitment (samaya) is the wisdom just as it was taught, and the realization is the Great Seal (Mahāmudrā), which is called Vajradhara himself under another name. That defining characteristic has been ascertained.

The passage beginning "Those" gives the benefits. "The qualities of a buddha" means all the qualities of a buddha, such as the powers and the forms of fearlessness. "Individually attaining the state" refers to what is to be attained and what is to be pursued: it means Akṣobhya. "Glory" is nondual clarity, that is, the Dharma body (dharmakāya). Because that is present in this, it is "glorious," meaning the three bodies: the body of intrinsic nature, the enjoyment body, and the emanation body. Here, "bliss" is the body of great bliss, which is qualified by that. The meaning is the Blessed One, the glorious Vajradhara, who is the embodiment of the five bodies. As for the realization of that ultimate result, whatever it is by which it is made manifest and ascertained, that is such a tantra. The text is the path, that which sets forth the result. Anāvila itself also bears another name: Glorious Great Bliss.

The commentary on the Anāvila, King of Mahāyoga Tantras, is complete.

From composing this commentary on the difficult points of the Anāvila,
whatever merit has arisen,
may the world, like the stainless young moon,
be unsullied, without exception.

Composed by the great master, the monk Kumāracandra.

Translator's Notes

• Several evident scribal slips are translated as corrected. "That one free of turbidity" supplies med pa, evidently dropped from rnyog pa de yang (compare the same phrase a few lines later). "The attributes" reads khyad par for khyab par. "From the very outset" reads gzod ma nyid nas for bzod pa nyid nas ("from patience itself"), as the same sentence goes on to say gzod ma nyid nas. "Cannot be examined" reads brtag par for rtag par. In the last line of the Vajracchedikā verse, "is not examined" reads mi dpyod for mi bskyod ("does not stir"), as the commentary's own gloss of that line has it. The sūtra passage on recollecting the Buddha ("neither from form nor from the uncharacterized Dharma") is obscure as transmitted and is translated as it stands. The glosses after the verse first take up the words of that sūtra passage in order (form, Dharma, mind, mentation) and only then the verse, so chos nyid in the first series is read as "the Dharma itself" rather than as dharmatā.
• "Being free of excitement, it is peaceful" renders rgod dang bcas pas, which as written says "together with excitement"; this contradicts the sense and the parallel phrases that follow ("since there is no slackness...", "being free of regret and doubt..."), which together list

hindrances whose absence the path entails, so the evident sense "free of" is translated. "This path too" reads lam 'di for las 'dis ("by this action"), since the whole discussion concerns the path and its "own side." In this section the commentary rereads the epithets of the opening passage of the tantra (without appearance, without example, inexpressible, not the nature of an object, peaceful, selfless, pure, and so on), which it earlier explained as the result, as a description of the path.

• "Teaches joy" reads dga' ba for dge ba ("virtue"), as the discussion of the four joys and moments that it opens requires. "Window" renders go'u, which ordinarily means a small casket or amulet box; the commentary's gloss about the eye seeing suggests a window of the maṇḍala palace, but this is uncertain. As written, the list of the uncontaminated aggregates gives four items; the usual list of five also includes liberation itself. The text assigns the wisdom of discernment to the south and the wisdom of equality to the west, and this is translated as it stands. Several lemmas in the section on the joys are obscure as transmitted ("the vajra and the lotus, the consort," "the joys reach the corners," "the joy of joy") and are rendered literally; "the consort" renders rig pa (vidyā).

• "The suffix carries the sense of beginning" renders dang po'i don gyi rkyen can; rkyen is here taken as the grammatical term "suffix" (pratyaya), the commentator noting that the participle "established" is used in its inceptive sense ("having begun to be established"). "The six families" renders rigs drug, which here means the six buddha families, whose lords are the six universal monarchs, not the six classes of beings. The phrase "upright and majestic like one holding a staff through the yoga of the essence" is obscure as transmitted and is rendered literally. The syllables go ku da ha na are the initials of the five kinds of meat (cow, dog, horse, elephant and human) taken as a tantric commitment, hence the commentator's reference to "the ox and the others."

• The commentator uses Sanskrit grammatical terms: "the seventh case" is the locative, and in the gloss on "bodhisattva" the nominative ("first case") is read as standing for the dative ("fourth case"), so that "sattva" is taken as the sentient beings for whose sake the bodhisattva acts; this reading of the two ordinals is interpretive. "Seminal fluid" and "flesh" are among the sacramental substances that tantric commitments correlate with the five buddhas. This text assigns the mirror-like wisdom to Vairocana and the wisdom of the dharmadhātu to Akṣobhya, the reverse of the more familiar arrangement; it is translated as it stands.

• The definition of wrong understanding is terse and its exact sense is uncertain; its closing comparison, literally "like not going forth" (that is, not renouncing), might instead mean "like what does not arise." The word rendered "Akṣobhya" also means simply "unshakable," so the gloss on "individually attaining the state" could instead mean "it means the unshakable state." "Glorious Great Bliss," given as another name of the Anāvila, is translated into English because its Sanskrit form cannot be confirmed. The closing verse plays on the author's name, Kumāracandra ("young moon"), and on the title Anāvila ("unsullied").

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of

spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.